SPIRIT GUARDIANS (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 3 – Conjuration
Casting Time: **Action** · Range: **Self** (15-foot Emanation)
Components: **V, S, M** (a prayer scroll) · Duration: **Concentration**, up to 10 minutes
Classes: Cleric

Protective spirits surround you in a **15-foot Emanation** for the duration. Their appearance depends on your alignment: angelic or fey if you are good or neutral (your choice), fiendish if you are evil. When you cast the spell, you can **designate** creatures that are unaffected. For the others, **Speed is halved** in the area.

A creature must succeed on a **Wisdom saving throw** when the Emanation enters its space, when it enters the area, or when it **ends its turn** there. On a failed save, it takes **3d8 Radiant damage** (good or neutral) or **Necrotic** damage (evil); half as much on a success. A creature makes this save **only once per turn**.

Using a Higher-Level Spell Slot: the damage increases by 1d8 for each slot level above 3.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You cast the spell (action): the spirits surround you at **15 ft** and **move with you**.
2. **Undesignated** creatures have their Speed halved in the area.
3. **Wisdom** save (your spell save DC) when the area enters their space, when they enter it or end their turn there: **once per turn**.
4. Failure: 3d8 damage, half on a success. You must keep **Concentration**.

⚠ Change from 2014

The area is an **Emanation** that moves with you. Saves happen when the Emanation enters a creature's space, when a creature enters the area, or when it ends its turn there. **Start of turn** is no longer a trigger. Each creature saves only **once per turn**. The component is a prayer scroll.

Step 1 – Cast the spell:

Use an **action**. Components V, S, and a prayer scroll. The spell requires your **Concentration** (up to 10 minutes). Cast it at level 3 or higher.

Step 2 – Designate unaffected creatures:

When you cast it, you designate the creatures you don't want to affect (your allies, for example). **Every other creature**, allies included, is affected.

Step 3 – Choose the appearance:

Angelic or fey if you are good or neutral, fiendish if you are evil. This sets the **damage type**: Radiant (good or neutral) or Necrotic (evil).

Step 4 – When creatures save:

- When the Emanation **enters their space** (you move toward them).
- When they **enter the area** (they move toward you).
- When they **end their turn** in the area.
- At most once per turn for each creature, including during other creatures' turns.

Example: Gwen (level 5 Cleric, spell save DC 15) casts the spell with a level 3 slot. A goblin enters the area and rolls 9 on the Wisdom save: failure. It takes 3d8, that is 6 + 3 + 5 = 14 Radiant damage. Its Speed is halved while it stays in the area.

Step 5 – End of the spell:

- The spell lasts **10 minutes** at most.
- It ends if your concentration is broken: damage with a failed Constitution saving throw, or the Incapacitated or Unconscious condition.

The text leaves several cases open. Here are the points that divide tables, with options to announce before the game.

Damage by slot level	Average
Level 3: 3d8	13.5
Level 4: 4d8	18
Level 5: 5d8	22.5
Level 6: 6d8	27
Level 7: 7d8	31.5
Level 8: 8d8	36
Level 9: 9d8	40.5

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

1 – Appearance at casting

The text doesn't say whether the Emanation "enters" the space of creatures already nearby when you cast. **Option**: yes, they save as soon as you cast; or no, only from their first move or the end of their turn.

2 – The carried caster

The spell follows the caster. An ally (mount, carrier, grappler) who moves them across the battlefield makes the Emanation enter many spaces. The text allows it, and each creature saves once per turn. **Options**: allow it; limit damage to the caster's own movement on their own turn; or once per round.

3 – Pushed or teleported creatures

A creature pushed or teleported into the area "enters" the Emanation. **Option**: it saves as for normal movement.

4 – Verticality

The text doesn't say how the Emanation is measured for flying or elevated creatures. **Option**: 15 ft in all directions.

5 – Alignment and damage type

The spell depends on your alignment. **Option**: the DM decides in case of doubt; an "Unaligned" character is treated as neutral.

Common table questions.

Are allies affected?

Yes, unless they are designated when you cast. Creatures can't be designated afterward.

Does the save happen at the start of the turn?

No: start of turn is no longer a trigger in 2024. The save happens when the Emanation enters the space, when a creature enters the area, or when it ends its turn there.

How many times per turn does a creature save?

Only once per turn, including during other creatures' turns.

Can I deal damage by moving forward?

Yes: when the Emanation enters a creature's space, it makes its save (once per turn).

Is the area difficult terrain?

No: the text halves Speed, with no mention of difficult terrain.

What if I lose concentration?

The spell ends: no more damage, no more Speed reduction.

What damage type do the spirits deal?

Radiant if you are good or neutral, Necrotic if you are evil.

Can I designate a creature I can't see?

The text speaks of creatures you designate when you cast. The DM decides whether an unseen creature can be designated. Table rule

Does the caster take the damage?

No: the Emanation starts from you and doesn't affect you.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Concentration: range and sight

To keep concentrating, you don't need to stay in range or keep the spell in sight, unless stated otherwise.

Concentration and Temporary HP

Temporary HP absorb damage but that damage counts for the concentration save DC (10 Temporary HP and 30 damage: DC 15).

Ending a spell

The caster can voluntarily end a spell that isn't instantaneous. *Dispel Magic* affects only spells.

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